MONTHLY UPDATE

Namibia: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Standards

FINANCE
New investments

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Data Storage · Cybersecurity

DPI
Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

DIGITALISATION
Digitalisation of sub-national government

TECHNOLOGY
AI · Innovation ecosystem

INCLUSION
Access to services

Governance

Legislation and regulation

REGULATIONS ON ACCREDITATION OF SECURITY PRODUCTS, SERVICES AND PROVIDERS

- **Regulations regarding Accreditation of Security Products and Services and Providers of such Products and Services (Electronic Transactions Act 4 of 2019)** — Legal Assistance Centre (LAC) Namibia, reproducing General Notice 953 of 2025 (Communications Regulatory Authority of Namibia), 17 December 2025

  Namibia's CRAN accreditation regime for certification service providers, in force from 15 June 2026.

FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS AND MARKETS ACT AND NAMFISA ACT

- **NAMFISA launches FinTech Square 2026 event to accelerate local innovation** — Namibia Economist, 18 September 2026

  FinTech Square 14 Oct 2026 in Windhoek to launch sandbox cohort 2 on crowdfunding and P2P lending.

- **Fintech will drive jobs, economic growth – Namfisa** — New Era, 21 September 2026

> The head of Namibia's financial regulator, Kenneth Matomola, said fintech could help with jobs and financial inclusion now that the Financial Institutions and Markets Act and a new Namfisa Act are in force. Both took effect on 1 May 2026. He cited youth unemployment of 44.4% in the 2023 labour force survey.

Data protection

> UNITED STATES HEALTH DATA AND SPECIMEN SHARING PROPOSAL

- **US To Phase Out HIV Support For Namibia After Data-Sharing Impasse** — Health Policy Watch, 8 September 2026

  $45m for fiscal 2027 then nothing, after Namibia refused US health-data and pathogen-sharing terms.

Regional collaboration

> AFCFTA DIGITAL TRADE REGULATORY ASSESSMENT

- **Namibia reviews digital trade framework for AfCFTA protocol implementation** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

  Namibia's assessment of its laws and institutions against the African free-trade area's Protocol on Digital Trade went to a validation workshop in Windhoek. It will feed a National Digital Trade Action Plan; no findings are published.

Standards

> HARMONISED GOVERNMENT COMMUNICATION STRATEGY

- **Namibia's economic armoury: How new government communication strategy could unlock multibillion-dollar investment** — Business Express, 13 September 2026

  Harmonised Government Communication Strategy 2026-2030 launched at NIPAM, Cabinet-approved in March 2026.

Finance

New investments

> UNIVERSAL SERVICE FUND ANNUAL ACCOUNTS

- **Namibia — Universal Service Fund Integrated Annual Report 2025** — Communications Regulatory Authority of Namibia (CRAN), for the Universal Service Fund, 1 September 2026

  Namibia's Universal Service Fund annual report: first statements, 18 months to 31 December 2025.

> UNIVERSAL SERVICE FUND PHASE 2 AWARD TO THE MOBILE OPERATOR

- **Namibia accelerates network modernization to meet growing connectivity needs - Namibia Daily News** — Namibia Daily News (Xinhua), 28 September 2026

  5G reaches five more towns; 19 new sites in nine regions; N$32.3m USF Phase 2 award for 10 towers in underserved areas.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

> QUARTERLY CONNECTIVITY USAGE

- **Cyber threats rise 57% despite ICT sector growth** — New Era, 18 September 2026

Namibia's communications regulator reports cyber threat events up 57 per cent and vulnerabilities up 40 per cent in the April-June quarter, alongside 2 per cent growth in mobile subscriptions to about 2.79 million and about N$243m invested in networks.

COMMERCIAL 5G NETWORK

- **Namibia accelerates network modernization to meet growing connectivity needs - Namibia Daily News** — Namibia Daily News (Xinhua), 28 September 2026

  Summarised under New investments.

LOW EARTH ORBIT SATELLITE BROADBAND SERVICE

- **Paratus Namibia launches Eutelsat's OneWeb LEO connectivity** — ITWeb Africa, 7 October 2026

  Capped and uncapped packages; follows November 2025 Eutelsat deal covering five southern African markets.

Data Storage

NATIONAL AND PUBLIC DATA CENTRE

- **AI to boost digital services: Theofelus** — New Era, 25 September 2026

  Minister cites ~89% 4G coverage; National Data Centre build begun at Kenya House; seat on ITU AI for Good Commission.

- **NCRST opens National AI Institute** — New Era, 25 September 2026

  CEO Peters: not 'merely a consumer' of foreign AI; NCRST-funded GPU computing at NUST and UNAM; 2,000 students.

Cybersecurity

REGULATOR AS ROOT CERTIFICATION AUTHORITY

- **Government told to stop making citizens carry ID copies** — observer24.com.na, 1 September 2026

  Namibia's National Root Certification Authority, operated by the communications regulator at the top of the country's digital trust chain, is technically live after a key-signing ceremony; the electronic signature provisions of the transactions act took effect on 15 June 2026.

- **Home Affairs becomes Namibia's first certification service provider** — New Era, 3 September 2026

  Four-year CRAN accreditation under the Electronic Transactions Act, after the 28 August key signing.

GLOBAL CYBERSECURITY INITIATIVE

- **Global Cybersecurity Initiative: Unifying Africa via Cybersecurity** — The Villager Newspaper, 4 September 2026

  Launched by DS Tech Namibia across seven markets, targeting 52 African countries by 2029.

RANSOMWARE ATTACK ON THE NAMIBIAN DEFENCE FORCE

- **Hackers hit NDF: RansomHouse threatens state secrets** — The Namibian, 20 September 2026

  A ransomware group listed the Namibian Defence Force among its victims and published an evidence pack it says shows access to the force's systems, with a message accusing its IT department of concealing the incident. No confirmation or response from the force is on record, and the defence minister said he had not heard of it.

- **Namibia's Defence Ministry hit by double-extortion ransomware attack** — Tech News Namibia, 20 September 2026

NAM-CSIRT confirms intrusion and attributes it to RansomHouse; data accessed not disclosed.

NATIONAL COMPUTER SECURITY INCIDENT RESPONSE TEAM

- **CRAN appoints Cornelia Shipindo to lead Namibia's cyber incident response** — TechNews Namibia, 3 October 2026

  Cornelia Shipindo takes over as NAM-CSIRT Executive from 1 October 2026, CRAN announces.

NATIONAL PUBLIC KEY INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Namibia strengthens digital trust** — Market Watch (Namibia Media Holdings), 4 October 2026

  Namibia's communications regulator launched DigiNam in Windhoek on 31 August as the public face of the national public key infrastructure, for which the regulator is root certification authority. It is meant to support electronic signatures, digital identity and authenticated online transactions under the Electronic Transactions Act of 2019.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

NATIONAL ELECTRONIC IDENTITY CARD

- **Government briefs lawmakers on new digital e-ID card** — Namibia Economist, 6 October 2026

  MPs pressed on cyber risk, backups, private-provider control and a proposed Resident Identity Card.

- **Namibia MPs press government on security, access and reach of planned digital ID | Biometric Update** — Biometric Update, 8 October 2026

  Namibian MPs questioned the planned digital ID on rural reach, cost, data ownership and cybersecurity at a briefing by two ministries. The rollout planned for September was delayed because the legal framework had not been finalised.

Digital Payments and Fintech

INSTANT PAYMENT SOLUTION

- **Explainer: What is WayaMe?** — The Namibian, 3 September 2026

  WayaMe is the public brand for Namibia's instant payment system, not a bank or a wallet of its own.

SOCIAL GRANT BENEFICIARIES LOCKED OUT OF THE PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **NamPost grant system faces scrutiny, elderly left stranded** — The Namibian, 7 September 2026

  Retired MP Elifas Dingara on beneficiaries travelling far and queueing only to find their names missing from the system.

- **5 700 grant beneficiaries still locked out of payment system** — Namibian Sun, 10 September 2026

  More than 5,700 Namibian pensioners and other social-grant beneficiaries remain locked out of the government payment system after their grants were suspended during an identity verification exercise earlier in 2026, the gender equality and child welfare minister told the National Assembly. She said 15,785 were affected in all, of whom 10,066 had verified their identities, been reinstated and paid, and defended the exercise as ensuring public money reaches only legitimate beneficiaries while acknowledging it had delayed vulnerable people.

Registries

MARRIAGE RECORDS DIGITALISATION

- **Home affairs minister Iipumbu urges married couples to ensure they are registered** — The Namibian, 10 October 2026

  Registers held by churches and courts; no delivery tracking; some records still in South Africa; digitised since 2021.

CHILD-GRANT PAYMENTS TO INELIGIBLE AND DECEASED RECIPIENTS

- **Audit finds N$28.8m in duplicate child grant payments** — The Namibian, 13 October 2026

  FY2024/25 audit: N$250m to over-age recipients, 3,350 duplicate records, N$43m to the dead; recoveries unestablished.

Sectoral management information systems

NATIONAL LABOUR MARKET INFORMATION SYSTEM (NALMIS)

- **NSA launches first labour market information system** — NAMPA, 25 September 2026

  Launched 24 Sep 2026 with the Justice and Labour ministry; one platform for government and private-sector labour data.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

DIGITAL DISABILITY ASSESSMENT SYSTEM

- **Digital disability system faces rural roadblocks** — The Namibian, 8 September 2026

  Advocates warn rural connectivity, equipment and digital skills gaps could turn the new assessment system into a barrier.

GOVERNMENT PENSION FUND INTEGRATED ADMINISTRATION SYSTEM

- **GIPF to invest N$40m in new pension administration system** — The Brief (Namibia), 23 September 2026

  N$40m system by Kenya's Cystech, under N$5m spent, 16-month build; data-sharing MoUs with NamRA, MoF, Home Affairs.

STANDARDISED REPORTING TEMPLATE FOR ONLINE GOVERNMENT SERVICES

- **Cabinet directs MICT to standardise online service reporting** — NAMPA, 8 October 2026

  Namibia's Cabinet directed the ICT ministry to develop a standard template for reporting which government services are available online.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

INNOVATE4WATER SMART WATER-METERING PILOT

- **Namibia project uses household data, smart meters to rethink water** — Science Granting Councils Initiative Africa, 21 September 2026

  Innovate4Water: 69 pulse readers in Ongwediva, AI on 1,375 Windhoek households; no verified loss reduction yet.

Technology

AI

AI AND SATELLITE CROP-MONITORING CONTRACT

- **US firm 6th Grain demands N$13m for cancelled crop tender** — The Namibian, 14 September 2026

  6th Grain demands N$13m after Cabinet ordered its crop-monitoring contract cancelled.

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE INSTITUTE

- **Namibia to launch AI institute to strengthen national capacity** — Namibia Business Review, 22 September 2026

  NCRST-run institute with four centres incl. a Namibian datasets centre; youth AI fellowship at ~2,000 students.

- **AI to boost digital services: Theofelus** — New Era, 25 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Storage.

- **NCRST opens National AI Institute** — New Era, 25 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Storage.

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE INSTITUTE

- **National AI Institute launched** — The Namibian, 27 September 2026

  Namibia's ICT minister launched a National Artificial Intelligence Institute in Windhoek, made up of software development, datasets, innovation and research centres. It is to work on skills, local datasets and uses in health, education, food security, energy and public services.

INTERNAL POLICY ON CIVIL SERVANTS' USE OF AI

- **Government directs AI policy for civil servants as ICT Summit opens in Ongwediva** — Namibia Economist, 13 October 2026

  Namibia's Cabinet has directed the Office of the Prime Minister and the ICT ministry to develop an internal policy on civil servants' use of artificial intelligence, the ICT minister announced at the National ICT Summit. No timeline or draft was given.

Innovation ecosystem

NON-BANK FINANCIAL REGULATOR'S REGULATORY SANDBOX

- **NAMFISA launches FinTech Square 2026 event to accelerate local innovation** — Namibia Economist, 18 September 2026

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Inclusion

Access to services

DIGITISATION OF DISABILITY ASSESSMENT AND GRANT ACCESS

- **Grant system goes digital to better serve disabled Namibians** — Namibian Sun, 8 September 2026

  Namibia is putting new guidelines and digital systems behind the medical assessment of persons with disabilities and their access to social grants.

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